

Quick Mnemonics For Nurses

Hypoglycemia – “TIRED”

Early symptoms to look for in Diabetes:

- **T** – Tachycardia
- **I** – Irritability
- **R** – Restlessness
- **E** – Excessive hunger
- **D** – Diaphoresis (sweating)

Hyperkalemia – “MURDER”

Severe symptoms of high potassium:

- **M** – Muscles Weakness
- **U** – Urine (oliguria/anuria)
- **R** – Respiratory difficulty
- **D** – Decreased cardiac contractility
- **E** – EKG changes
- **R** – Reflexes

Quick Mnemonics For Nurses

Heart Failure – “FACES”

Helps remember symptoms of chronic heart failure

- **F** – Fatigue
- **A** – Activities limited
- **C** – Chest congestion
- **E** – Edema
- **S** – Shortness of breath

Stroke – “FAST”

Used to identify signs of stroke quickly

- **F** – Face drooping
- **A** – Arm Weakness
- **S** – Speech Difficulty
- **T** – Time to call 911

Quick Mnemonics For Nurses

Diabetes – “DIABETIC”

Key nursing intervention and monitoring:

- **D** – Diet
- **I** – Insulin
- **A** – Activity (exercise)
- **B** – Blood glucose Monitoring
- **E** – Education
- **T** – Testing (HbA1c, urine)
- **I** – Identify complication
- **C** – Consult healthcare team

Parkinson's Disease – “TRAP”

Classic symptoms

- **T** – Tremor at rest
- **R** – Rigidity
- **A** – Akinesia or (bradykinesia)
- **P** – Postural Instability

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Asthma – “**ASTHMA**”

Common Symptoms

- **A** – Accessory muscle use
- **S** – Shortness of Breath
- **T** – Tight Chest
- **H** – High pitched wheezing
- **M** – Minimal air exchange
- **A** – Anxiety

Anemia – “**PALER**”

General symptoms

- **P** – Pallor
- **A** – Anorexia
- **L** – Lethargy
- **E** – Exertional dyspnea
- **R** – Reduced hemoglobin

Quick Mnemonics For Nurses

COPD – “Lung Damage”

Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease

Symptoms:

- **L** – Lack of energy
- **U** – Unable to tolerate activity
- **N** – Nutrition poor (Weight loss)
- **G** – Gases abnormal (CO_2 up, O_2 down)
- **D** – Dry or productive cough
- **A** – Accessory muscle usage for breathing
- **M** – Modification of skin color (cyanosis)

Pneumonia – “PRODUCTIVE”

Assessment findings in a pneumonia patient

- **P** – Productive Cough
- **R** – Rales/Rhonchi
- **O** – Onset sudden
- **D** – Dyspnea
- **U** – Unusual fatigue
- **C** – Chest Pain
- **T** – Temperature elevated
- **I** – Increased HR and RR
- **V** – Very ill appearance
- **E** – Egophony (E sounds like A over affected area)